

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 32

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

In the third chapter of his letter, James teaches us to observe our words. Your words tell you a lot about the health of your soul. What comes out of your mouth—not just your words but your tone and delivery also—is a kind of fruit, and that fruit is the evidence of what you carry in your heart all the time. In an unguarded moment or in moments of distress, self-hate, or euphoria, your words can tell you and others how your soul is really doing. However, we often do not pay attention to what comes out of our mouth. So, ask a friend to reflect back to you what they notice. This is a time for humility not self-defense—but remember to celebrate when your spontaneous words reveal the growing health of your soul and when your verbal interchanges with others indicate encouraging progress toward orientation.

In the Toolbox we talked about the CORE muscles of the soul. When your CORE is weak, you cannot stand in the face of compulsive behaviors, old habits, or sudden provocations; every part of you is vulnerable to weakness and injury. Unless your CORE muscles have been trained to be strong, you will be weak just when you need your strength the most.

If you want to live an oriented life, you must accept the reality that you have an enemy. Your enemy is determined to undermine any effort you make toward restoring your True Self. When you waste your energy searching for a counterfeit glory, you are pridefully opposing God and cooperating with the enemy who seeks to sabotage God's plan for your life, your mission, and your glory. In his letter to the Ephesians, Paul teaches us to perpetually keep our enemy in mind. If, however, you choose to live in the lazy illusion that there is no enemy and make no effort to train, you will be vulnerable to enemy attack. Healthy fear of a real enemy motivates us to secure our boundaries and guard the ground that we have gained. It may seem like a paradox, but fear can be your friend. Fear can motivate you to undergo the difficult but necessary training that prepares you to meet the enemy and gives you real self-confidence in the fight.

Let's look at Nancy's paraphrase of **Ephesians 6:10–18** where Paul teaches us how prepare for this good fight.

¹⁰And one more thing, learn to take up your abilities in the Lord and take them up in the strength that comes from doing things His way. ¹¹Put on the complete armor of God, as when one warrior gifts his armor to another, and move toward the goal of having the ability to stand against

the schemes of the slanderer and the Idol Self. ¹²We need this divine armor from God because our battle is not against material creatures, but against the things that rule them, against the actual authorities in their lives, against the governors of their world-system—this present darkness that confronts us—and against spiritual things that cause injury in the world beyond this world. ¹³So you see, you cannot fight this battle for your own soul without the proper equipment. Take up the complete armor of God, for He has passed this battle on to you, in order that when those days of injury threaten you, you may be able to stand against it—and doing all that you can, to stand. ¹⁴In case you have not understood, you must stand! Wrap your core muscles with truth and cover your vital organs with orientation. ¹⁵Keep your shoes on, prepared with the good news of peace at every moment. ¹⁶And in all that you do, take up the shield of trust—of believing it—with which you can extinguish all the incoming missiles that are thrown at you by those who seek to inflame and provoke you into believing that you have been injured. ¹⁷And solemnly receive the helmet that identifies you as one who has been rescued from all of this and, also, protects your thoughts and declares your loyalty. Receive also the sword of the Spirit and the breath, which is all that God has spoken about who you are. ¹⁸With a cultivated attitude of sacred prayer, make requests in every moment and with every breath; pray with your spirit. Always keep awake; stay alert with obstinate persistence. Keep making requests concerning the saints—I mean those who are your fellow soldiers and, like you, have set themselves apart to serve the purposes of God.

Take a deep breath.

Paul is not saying in this passage that you can never rest. In fact, he is teaching you how to maintain a state of alert relaxation, trusting in the quality of your armor. If you put on God's armor, which is a metaphor for all the oriented qualities that you need for the fight, your enemies both within and without will no longer have power over you. Whether the enemy is Satan, your Idol Self, or the Idol Self of others is immaterial. What is important is that you acknowledge the reality that you have an enemy. Keep learning to stand when things get rough. If you rely on the armor of orientation, you no longer need to run back to your old habits of relieving tension and restoring pride. You can just stand using your CORE muscles.

You may have judged people who are compelled by neurotic needs and self-hate, but now you can peacefully believe it and offer the good news of peace by being at peace. With God's armor, you can protect yourself from the fiery missiles of others that seek to pierce your soul and ignite mindless reactions. Just stand, believing rather than judging what people choose and what people do, knowing that you do not have to participate. Spot the fools quickly and circumvent them. Recognize the wise. Walk with them and cling to them. This is the safest place for you to be.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord of the armies of God, teach me to stand. (Repeat)

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time of healing and training together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You continue to teach us how to stand. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and mission, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.